OurMocks

2027 CYCLE

MOCK · PRACTICE · CRACK

CUET UG

Political Science

International Organisations in a Unipolar World

Unit IV · UN Structure, Specialized Agencies, Security Council Reform & Global Governance · CUET UG 2027 Mastery

INSIDE
Concept Notes

INSIDE
Solved Examples

INSIDE
Practice MCQs + Solutions

Aligned to the latest official syllabus · Concept-first explanations

www.ourmocks.com

Syllabus Alignment & Chapter Architecture

Sub-Topic Domain	Official NTA CUET UG Unit IV Syllabus Scope	High-Frequency Cognitive Skills Tested
Why International Organisations?	Rationale for multilateral bodies; conflict management and global public goods; sovereign equality vs functional hierarchy; limitations of global governance without world government.	Evaluating functions of multilateral diplomacy; analyzing collective action problems; assessing sovereign state limitations.
Genesis & Organs of the UN	Failure of League of Nations; Atlantic Charter (1941); San Francisco Conference (1945); UN Day (24 Oct 1945); India's entry (30 Oct 1945); six principal organs: UNGA, UNSC, Secretariat, ICJ, ECOSOC, Trusteeship Council (suspended 1994).	Tracing institutional evolution; differentiating voting procedures; recalling terms, judicial jurisdictions, and key leadership tenures.
UN Restructuring & Reform	Post-Cold War geopolitical shifts; structural vs jurisdictional reform; Kofi Annan's 1997 six criteria for permanent UNSC seats; 2005 World Summit milestones: Peacebuilding Commission, UNHRC (2006), Responsibility to Protect (R2P), Democracy Fund.	Deconstructing UNSC expansion debates; evaluating reform criteria; analyzing jurisdictional tensions between sovereignty and human protection.
India's Candidature for UNSC	India's claim for permanent membership: population, democracy, economic scale, UN peacekeeping troop contributions; obstacles: P5 veto resistance, Chinese opposition, 'Coffee Club' (Uniting for Consensus).	Constructing arguments for global representation; evaluating geopolitical roadblocks; analyzing G4 coordination dynamics.
Bretton Woods & Trade Bodies	IMF: quota-based weighted voting, US veto power (16.5%+), structural adjustment programs; World Bank: developmental lending; WTO: successor to GATT (1995), TRIPS, dispute settlement, power asymmetries.	Analyzing financial governance mechanics; evaluating asymmetric voting weights; contrasting free-trade regimes with developing-world interests.
IAEA, NGOs & Unipolar Hegemony	IAEA (Vienna, 1957, Atoms for Peace); global NGOs: Amnesty International (1961), Human Rights Watch (1978); US dominance, financial leverage (22% budget), unilateralism (Iraq 2003); indispensability of the UN as a global forum.	Evaluating nuclear safeguards regimes; assessing watchdog role of global civil society; analyzing multilateralism under unipolarity.

CUET HIGH-SCORING INSIGHT & KEY COGNITIVE TRAPS

Theme 4 requires precision on dates, headquarters, voting rules, and reform institutions:

1. **Founding Dates and India's Accession:**
   - UN Charter signed: **26 June 1945** (San Francisco); came into force: **24 October 1945** (UN Day).
   - **India signed on 30 October 1945** as an original founding member (51st member was Poland, which signed on 15 Oct 1945).

- 193rd member state: **South Sudan** (admitted in **July 2011**).

2. **Principal Organs Details:**
   - **ICJ:** 15 judges, 9-year terms, seated in **The Hague, Netherlands** (only principal organ outside New York).
   - **Trusteeship Council:** Suspended operations on **1 November 1994** following the independence of Palau.
   - **UNSC Non-Permanent Members:** 10 members, elected for **2-year terms**, **cannot** be immediately re-elected.
3. **New Bodies Established in 2005/2006:**
   - **Human Rights Council (UNHRC):** Created by UNGA on **15 March 2006**, replacing the Commission on Human Rights.
   - **Peacebuilding Commission:** Created at the 60th Anniversary World Summit in **September 2005**.
   - **R2P (Responsibility to Protect):** Formally endorsed by world leaders at the 2005 World Summit.
4. **Economic Bodies Headquarters & Founding:**
   - **IMF & World Bank:** Established at **Bretton Woods (1944)**; headquartered in **Washington, D.C.**
   - **WTO:** Succeeded GATT on **1 January 1995**; headquartered in **Geneva, Switzerland**.
   - **IAEA:** Established in **1957** under Eisenhower's "Atoms for Peace"; headquartered in **Vienna, Austria**.

1. The Imperative for International Organisations

In an anarchic international system composed of sovereign nation-states, international organisations are not supranational world governments. They possess no sovereign authority over independent nations, nor do they command independent standing armies. Instead, they represent vital multilateral instruments:

Facilitating Cooperation in an Interdependent World

- **The Philosophy of Multilateralism:** Former UN Secretary-General **Dag Hammarskjöld** famously captured the core philosophical justification of the world body: **"The United Nations was not created to take mankind to heaven, but to save humanity from hell."** International organisations provide regularized institutional mechanisms for dialogue, arbitration, and de-escalation, preventing misunderstandings from degenerating into catastrophic armed warfare.
- **Provision of Global Public Goods:** In the modern globalized epoch, sovereign states face existential collective action problems that no individual nation—regardless of military might or economic wealth—can resolve unilaterally:
  - **Transboundary Environmental Crises:** Anthropogenic climate change, ozone layer depletion, and global marine pollution require universally binding emissions regulations.
  - **Global Pandemics:** Controlling viral outbreaks (such as smallpox, polio, and COVID-19) requires coordinated real-time epidemiological surveillance, vaccine distribution, and technical assistance.

- **International Communication and Transportation:** Global aviation, maritime navigation corridors, satellite communications, and cyberspace management depend fundamentally on standardized multilateral protocols.

Sovereign Equality vs Structural Hierarchy

While the foundational principle of international law affirms the **sovereign equality** of all nation-states, the operational mechanics of international institutions invariably reflect real-world distributions of economic, military, and diplomatic power.

2. Evolution and Principal Organs of the United Nations

The United Nations was forged during the Second World War as the successor to the failed **League of Nations**, which had collapsed due to structural deficiencies and its inability to thwart fascist aggression in the 1930s:

Historical Steps Leading to the San Francisco Charter

- **Atlantic Charter (August 1941):** Signed aboard the warship HMS Prince of Wales by US President Franklin D. Roosevelt and British Prime Minister Winston Churchill, establishing foundational principles for post-war peace.
- **Declaration by United Nations (January 1942):** Representatives of 26 Allied nations endorsed the Atlantic Charter, adopting the term "United Nations" coined by President Roosevelt.
- **Yalta Conference (February 1945):** The "Big Three" (Roosevelt, Churchill, and Joseph Stalin) finalized plans for the post-war security organisation and agreed upon the Security Council voting procedure.
- **San Francisco Conference (April–June 1945):** Delegates from 50 nations convened at the United Nations Conference on International Organization to draft the Charter of the United Nations, signed on **26 June 1945**. Poland, absent from the conference, signed later on 15 October 1945, bringing the total number of original founding members to 51.
- **Entry into Legal Force (24 October 1945):** The UN officially came into legal existence on **24 October 1945**, following ratification of the Charter by the P5 and a majority of signatories. **24 October** is celebrated globally as **United Nations Day**.
- **India's Accession:** India formally signed the UN Charter on **30 October 1945**, entering the organization as an original founding member state prior to achieving formal independence.
- **Universal Membership:** The UN expanded from its original 51 members to 193 sovereign states, with **South Sudan** admitted as the 193rd member state in **July 2011**.

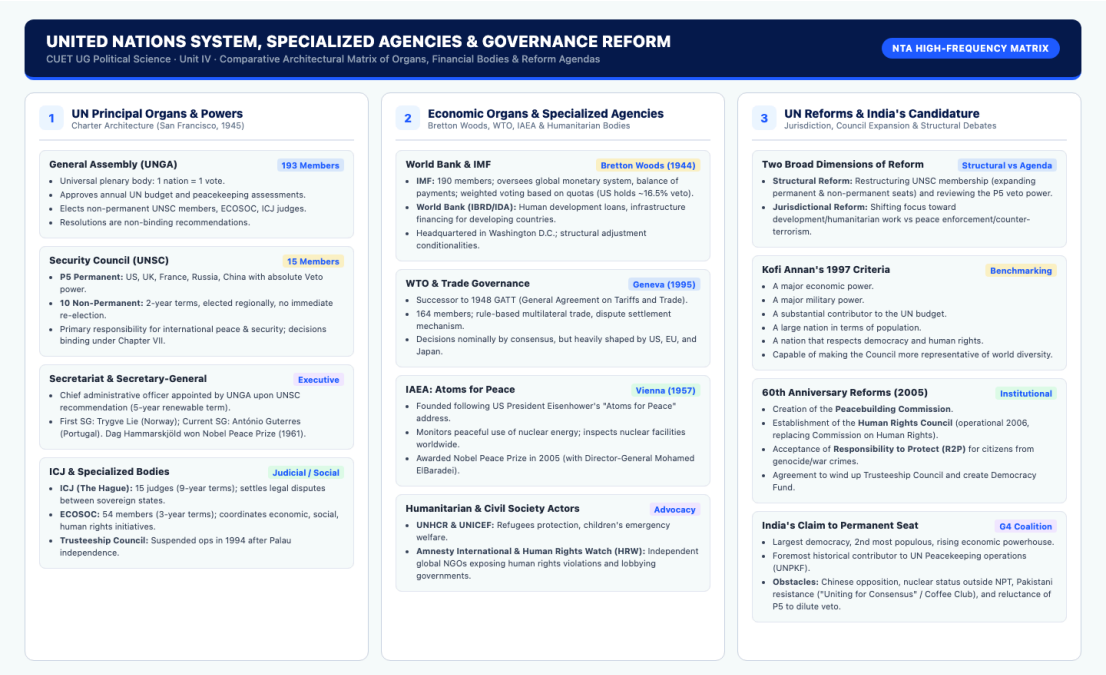


Figure 1: Figure 1 — United Nations Architectural Matrix: Principal organs, judicial bodies, Bretton Woods financial institutions, specialized agencies, and 2005 reform mechanisms.

The Six Principal Organs of the UN Architecture

1. **The General Assembly (UNGA):**
   - The primary deliberative, representative, and policymaking organ composed of all 193 member states.
   - Operates strictly on the principle of **"one state, one vote"**.
   - Decides vital questions—including recommendations on peace and security, election of non-permanent Security Council members, and approval of the UN budget—by a **two-thirds majority**. Other questions require a simple majority.
   - Resolutions passed by the General Assembly are politically influential but legally **non-binding** recommendations.
2. **The Security Council (UNSC):**
   - Entrusted under the UN Charter with primary responsibility for maintaining international peace and security.
   - Consists of **15 members**: **5 Permanent Members (P5)**—the United States, the United Kingdom, France, the Russian Federation (which inherited the Soviet seat in 1991), and the People's Republic of China (which replaced Taiwan in 1971)—and **10 Non-Permanent Members**.
   - Non-permanent members are elected by the General Assembly for staggered **two-year terms** according to regional geographical quotas. They **cannot be immediately re-elected** upon the completion of their two-year term.
   - **The Veto Power (Article 27):** Substantive decisions require 9 affirmative votes, including the concurring votes of all five permanent members. A single negative vote cast by any P5 member constitutes a **veto**, completely defeating the resolution even if supported by the remaining 14 members.
3. **The Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC):**
   - Comprises **54 member states** elected by the General Assembly for overlapping **three-year terms**.

- Coordinates the international economic, social, cultural, educational, and health work of the UN system, serving as the central forum for discussing international development goals and supervising specialized agencies (such as WHO, UNESCO, ILO, and UNICEF).

4. **The International Court of Justice (ICJ):**
   - The principal judicial organ of the United Nations, seated permanently at the Peace Palace in **The Hague, Netherlands** (the only principal organ not located at UN Headquarters in New York).
   - Comprises **15 judges** elected for **nine-year terms** by simultaneous absolute majority votes in both the General Assembly and the Security Council.
   - Adjudicates legal disputes between sovereign states and delivers advisory opinions on legal questions referred by authorized UN organs and specialized agencies.
5. **The Secretariat & The Secretary-General:**
   - The administrative backbone of the UN, comprising international civil servants administering programs and policies.
   - Headed by the **Secretary-General**, the chief administrative officer appointed by the General Assembly upon the formal recommendation of the Security Council for a renewable **five-year term**.
   - The Secretary-General personifies the moral authority of the UN, utilizing "good offices" diplomacy to mediate international disputes.
6. **The Trusteeship Council:**
   - Established to supervise the administration of 11 trust territories placed under the International Trusteeship System to prepare them for self-governance or independence.
   - With the independence of **Palau** (the last remaining trust territory) on 1 October 1994, the Trusteeship Council formally **suspended its operations on 1 November 1994**, agreeing to meet only as occasion required.



Figure 2: Figure 2 — Thematic Chronology & Security Council Reform Architecture: Evolution of the UN, Kofi Annan's 1997 permanent seat criteria, G4 coalition strategy, and post-Cold War institutional milestones.

3. Reforming the United Nations: Structure, Processes and Jurisdiction

Following the collapse of the Soviet Union and the conclusion of the Cold War, the international system underwent profound geopolitical transformations. The existing UN architecture, conceived in 1945, faced intensifying criticism as obsolete and unrepresentative:

Structural vs Jurisdictional Reform Dimensions

The ongoing debate over restructuring the UN divides into two broad domains:

1. **Reform of Structures and Decision-Making Processes:** Primarily focused on expanding the membership of the UN Security Council in both permanent and non-permanent categories, rationalizing the use of the veto power, and democratizing the General Assembly.
2. **Review of Jurisdictional Scope:** Debating whether the UN should prioritize developmental, humanitarian, environmental, and socio-economic programs or concentrate its resources on preventive diplomacy, peace enforcement, counter-terrorism, and post-conflict peacekeeping.

Kofi Annan's 1997 Criteria for Permanent Membership

In 1997, Secretary-General **Kofi Annan** initiated a comprehensive inquiry into Security Council reform, proposing that any aspiring candidate for permanent membership should satisfy six fundamental qualitative and quantitative criteria:

- **1. Economic Scale:** The candidate must be a major economic power capable of underwriting international development and crisis stabilization.
- **2. Military Stature:** The candidate must maintain substantial military capabilities to contribute decisively to international peace enforcement.
- **3. Financial Commitment:** The candidate must be a substantial contributor to the regular operating and peacekeeping budgets of the United Nations.
- **4. Demographic Weight:** The candidate must represent a substantial segment of global humanity in terms of population size.
- **5. Constitutional Values:** The candidate must demonstrate an established record of respecting democracy, fundamental human rights, and the rule of law.
- **6. Global Representativeness:** The inclusion of the candidate must make the Security Council genuinely reflective of the cultural, geographic, and socio-economic diversity of the contemporary international community.

Landmark Decisions of the 2005 World Summit

In September 2005, heads of state convened in New York for the 60th Anniversary World Summit to mark six decades of the United Nations, agreeing upon historic institutional additions:

- **Establishment of the Peacebuilding Commission:** Designed as an intergovernmental advisory body to mobilize international resources and coordinate peacebuilding strategies for war-ravaged states transitioning from conflict to sustainable recovery.
- **Creation of the UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC):** On **15 March 2006**, the General Assembly voted overwhelmingly to establish the 47-member Human Rights Council, officially replacing the discredited Commission on Human Rights to conduct universal periodic reviews of human rights records.
- **Endorsement of the Responsibility to Protect (R2P):** Recognized that sovereign states have the primary responsibility to protect their own populations from genocide, war crimes, ethnic cleansing, and crimes against humanity. When a state fails to do so, the international

community has the collective responsibility to intervene through diplomatic, humanitarian, or coercive Security Council measures.

- **UN Democracy Fund (UNDEF):** Established to channel direct grants to grassroots civil society organizations and democratic institutions worldwide.

4. India's Candidature for Permanent Membership in the Security Council

India has maintained an unwavering diplomatic campaign advocating for the permanent restructuring and democratization of the UN Security Council:

Substantive Foundations of India's Bid

India's candidature fulfills every parameter outlined in Kofi Annan's 1997 reform criteria:

- **Demographic Supremacy:** With a population exceeding 1.4 billion people, India represents one-sixth of the total human population on Earth. A Security Council that excludes one-sixth of humanity cannot claim genuine global legitimacy.
- **World's Largest Democracy:** India has sustained an unbroken constitutional democratic framework since independence, conducting massive, peaceful democratic general elections based on universal adult franchise, judicial independence, and vibrant civil liberties.
- **Economic Dynamism:** India stands as the world's fifth-largest economy by nominal GDP and the third-largest by Purchasing Power Parity (PPP), functioning as a primary locomotive of global economic growth and technological innovation.
- **Exemplary Peacekeeping Contributions:** India has historically been one of the foremost cumulative contributors of personnel to UN Peacekeeping Operations (UNPKOs), participating in over 50 missions across four continents and sacrificing more peacekeepers in the line of duty than any other sovereign nation.
- **Civilizational Footprint & Global South Leadership:** India has consistently championed the sovereign interests of developing nations through the Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) and the G77, articulating the developmental aspirations of the Global South.

Geopolitical Coalitions and Institutional Roadblocks

Despite the undeniable legitimacy of India's claim, significant institutional and diplomatic barriers impede Security Council reform:

- **The G4 Coalition:** India coordinates its diplomatic campaign alongside **Brazil, Germany, and Japan** (the **Group of Four or G4**), mutually supporting each other's aspirations for permanent seats while engaging with the African Union.
- **The "Coffee Club" (Uniting for Consensus):** A coalition of regional rivals—spearheaded by **Pakistan** (opposing India), **Italy** (opposing Germany), **Argentina** (opposing Brazil), and **South Korea** (opposing Japan)—that strongly opposes expanding permanent seats, arguing instead for expanding non-permanent rotating seats.
- **The P5 Reluctance and the Veto Dilemma:** Existing permanent members are deeply reluctant to dilute their exclusive privileges. While four P5 members (US, UK, France, Russia) have expressed bilateral support for India's candidature, **China** continues to deploy ambiguous diplomatic maneuvers to block substantive negotiations. Furthermore, the P5 remains steadfastly opposed to granting the veto power to any new permanent members.

5. New International Economic Organisations: Power and Asymmetry

Global economic governance is dominated by powerful multilateral financial and trade institutions that reflect the historical dominance of Western industrialized nations:

The Bretton Woods Institutions: IMF and World Bank (1944)

Convened at the Bretton Woods Conference in New Hampshire, USA, in July 1944, delegates designed an international monetary framework to avoid the competitive devaluations and trade wars that triggered the Great Depression:

- **The International Monetary Fund (IMF):**
  - Comprises 190 member states, overseeing the international monetary system, exchange rate stability, and macroeconomic management.
  - **Weighted Voting and the US Veto:** Voting power in the IMF is not based on the democratic principle of "one country, one vote." Instead, voting shares are pegged directly to the financial quotas contributed by each member state.
  - The **United States holds approximately 16.5% of total voting power**. Because major institutional amendments and structural policy changes require an **85% supermajority**, the US holds an absolute **unilateral veto** over all major IMF decisions.
  - The combined G7 advanced economies control over 40% of the total voting power, ensuring Western domination of global liquidity allocation.
  - **Structural Adjustment Programs (SAPs):** IMF emergency loans come tethered to stringent austerity conditionalities, forcing borrowing developing nations to slash social welfare expenditures, privatize state assets, and open domestic markets to multinational capital.
- **The World Bank (IBRD and IDA):**
  - Focuses on long-term developmental financing, extending low-interest loans, grants, and technical assistance for infrastructure, agricultural modernization, education, and public health in developing economies.
  - **Institutional Convention:** By long-standing unwritten diplomatic custom, the President of the World Bank is always an American citizen nominated by the US President, whereas the Managing Director of the IMF is traditionally a European national.

The World Trade Organization (WTO, 1995)

- **Genesis:** Established on **1 January 1995** following the conclusion of the Uruguay Round and the signing of the Marrakesh Agreement, succeeding the provisional **General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT, 1948)**. Headquartered in **Geneva, Switzerland**, it currently encompasses 164 member states.
- **Mandate & Scope:** Unlike GATT, which dealt almost exclusively with trade in manufactured goods, the WTO encompasses international trade in **goods, cross-border services (GATS)**, and **intellectual property rights (TRIPS)**, backed by a binding Dispute Settlement Mechanism (DSM).
- **Decision-Making and Democratic Deficits:** While WTO decisions are formally taken by consensus, major commercial agreements are frequently negotiated behind closed doors in informal "Green Room" consultations dominated by the US, the European Union, Japan, and other advanced economies, leaving developing nations with little choice but to acquiesce to asymmetrical trade rules.

6. Specialized Agencies and Autonomous International Bodies

The United Nations system encompasses numerous autonomous specialized agencies, funds, and programs that operate under the coordination of ECOSOC and the General Assembly:

International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA, 1957)

- **Origins:** Established in **1957** in **Vienna, Austria**, following US President Dwight D. Eisenhower's famous **"Atoms for Peace"** address before the UN General Assembly in December 1953.
- **Dual Mandate:** Promotes the safe and peaceful utilization of nuclear energy for electricity generation, cancer therapy, and agricultural irradiation, while administering rigorous international **safeguards** and on-site reactor inspections to prevent the diversion of civilian fissile material toward nuclear weapons.
- **Recognition:** The IAEA and its Director-General **Mohamed ElBaradei** were jointly awarded the **Nobel Peace Prize in 2005** for their efforts to prevent nuclear energy from being used for military purposes.

Key UN Humanitarian and Developmental Agencies

- **UN High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR):** Headquartered in Geneva; protects displaced populations and coordinates international refugee relief (awarded Nobel Peace Prizes in 1954 and 1981).
- **United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF):** Headquartered in New York; advocates for children's rights, immunizations, and emergency child welfare (awarded Nobel Peace Prize in 1965).
- **World Health Organization (WHO):** Headquartered in Geneva; leads global public health directives, disease eradication programs (such as the eradication of smallpox in 1980), and pandemic monitoring.
- **UNESCO:** Headquartered in Paris; fosters international collaboration in education, cultural heritage preservation, and scientific advancement.

7. Global Civil Society & Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs)

The post-Cold War era witnessed the dramatic rise of transnational non-governmental organisations that act as independent watchdogs, monitoring government actions and holding sovereign states accountable to international humanitarian norms:

Prominent Human Rights Watchdogs

- **Amnesty International:**
  - Founded in London in **1961** by British lawyer **Peter Benenson**, inspired by the unjust imprisonment of Portuguese students who toasted to freedom.
  - Mobilizes grassroots public campaigns, publishes authoritative global reports on human rights violations, campaigns for the release of **prisoners of conscience**, and advocates for the universal abolition of torture and capital punishment.
  - Awarded the **Nobel Peace Prize in 1977**.
- **Human Rights Watch (HRW):**
  - Established in 1978 (originally founded as Helsinki Watch to monitor Soviet compliance with the 1975 Helsinki Accords).

- Conducts rigorous fact-finding investigations into wartime atrocities, unlawful civilian killings, child soldier recruitment, and state repression, leveraging international media and diplomatic pressure to compel policy changes.

8. Multilateral Governance in an Era of Unipolarity

How democratic, autonomous, and effective can international organisations remain in an international system marked by United States military preponderance?

Structural Dimensions of American Hegemony

- **Financial & Physical Leverage:** The UN Headquarters is situated on US sovereign territory in **New York City**, and the United States remains the single largest financial contributor, underwriting approximately **22% of the regular UN operating budget**.
- **Unilateral Military Interventions:** When the UN Security Council refused to authorize the invasion of Iraq in 2003, the United States proceeded to launch military strikes unilaterally through a self-styled "Coalition of the Willing," underscoring the limitations of international law in constraining a superpower.
- **Veto Diplomacy:** Washington frequently exercises its permanent veto in the Security Council to shield itself and its key geopolitical allies from international censure.

Why the UN Remains an Irreplaceable Global Forum

Despite its structural limitations, the United Nations remains an indispensable global institution:

- **The Sole Universal Arena:** It is the only universal international forum where all 193 sovereign nation-states assemble on terms of sovereign equality to deliberate on war, peace, and human development.
- **Legitimacy & Platform for the Developing World:** It provides smaller, vulnerable nations and the Global South with an institutional megaphone to challenge great-power hegemony, advance decolonization, and coordinate humanitarian assistance that saves millions of lives annually.

OurMocks

Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap



Figure 3: Figure 3 — International Organisations Summary Mindmap: Complete structural map of UN organs, Kofi Annan's reform criteria, India's UNSC claim, Bretton Woods bodies, specialized agencies, and global NGOs.

HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS & HISTORIOGRAPHICAL POINTERS

- **UN Day:** Celebrated annually on **24 October** (the date the Charter entered into force in 1945).
- **India's Accession Date:** India signed the UN Charter on **30 October 1945** as an original founding member.
- **193rd Member of the UN: South Sudan** was admitted in **July 2011**.
- **ICJ Structure:** Seated at **The Hague, Netherlands**; 15 judges elected for **9-year terms**.
- **Trusteeship Council:** Suspended operations on **1 November 1994** following the independence of Palau.
- **Kofi Annan's 1997 Criteria:** Six criteria for new permanent UNSC members (economic, military, budget, population, democracy, diversity).
- **New 2005/2006 Bodies:** Peacebuilding Commission (2005), UN Human Rights Council (March 2006, replacing Commission on Human Rights).
- **IMF Voting Power:** United States holds **16.5%** voting power, yielding a unilateral veto over major structural decisions.
- **WTO Founding:** Founded on **1 January 1995** via Marrakesh Agreement, succeeding GATT (1948); based in Geneva.
- **IAEA:** Founded in **1957** in **Vienna, Austria**, following Eisenhower's "Atoms for Peace" address (1953).

MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — INTERNATIONAL ORGANISATIONS

▸**UN Charter Chronology:** Atlantic Charter (1941) → Declaration by UN (1942) → Yalta (Feb 1945) → San Francisco (June 1945) → Official Inception (24 Oct 1945) → India joins (30 Oct 1945). ▸**Six Principal Organs:** UNGA (193 members, 1 state = 1 vote); UNSC (P5 with veto + 10 non-permanent with 2-yr terms); ECOSOC (54 members, 3-yr terms); ICJ (15 judges, 9-yr terms, The Hague); Secretariat (Secretary-General, 5-yr term); Trusteeship Council (suspended 1994). ▸**Secretaries-General Milestones:** Trygve Lie (1st SG) → Dag Hammarskjöld (Peacekeeping pioneer, 1961 crash, Nobel) → U Thant (Cuban missile crisis) → Kofi Annan (1997 reform criteria, MDGs) → Ban Ki-moon (Paris Agreement, SDGs) → António Guterres (Current). ▸**2005/2006 Reform Milestones:** Peacebuilding Commission (2005); UN Human Rights Council (2006); Responsibility to Protect (R2P, 2005); Democracy Fund (2005). ▸**Economic & Specialized Bodies:** IMF (Bretton Woods 1944, US 16.5% veto); World Bank (IBRD/IDA, Washington); WTO (1995, Geneva, TRIPS); IAEA (1957, Vienna, Atoms for Peace); UNHCR (1950, Geneva); UNICEF (1946, New York). ▸**Global Civil Society NGOs:** Amnesty International (London 1961, Peter Benenson, Nobel 1977); Human Rights Watch (1978, Helsinki Watch).

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS

1. **Trap 1 (UN Day vs India's Accession Date):** UN Day is celebrated on **24 October 1945**, but India signed the Charter on **30 October 1945**. Do not confuse these two dates!
2. **Trap 2 (Location of the ICJ):** The International Court of Justice is seated in **The Hague, Netherlands**, NOT in New York or Geneva.
3. **Trap 3 (Non-Permanent UNSC Term & Re-election):** Non-permanent members serve **two-year terms** and **cannot** be immediately re-elected.
4. **Trap 4 (Trusteeship Council vs Human Rights Council):** The Trusteeship Council was **suspended in 1994**; the Human Rights Council was newly created in **2006** (replacing the Commission on Human Rights).
5. **Trap 5 (WTO Founding Year):** The WTO was established on **1 January 1995** via the Marrakesh Agreement, NOT in 1948 (which was GATT) or 1991.
6. **Trap 6 (IAEA Headquarters):** IAEA is headquartered in **Vienna, Austria**, NOT in Geneva or Paris.
7. **Trap 7 (IMF Voting Power):** The IMF does NOT follow "one nation, one vote"; voting is quota-based, giving the US an effective unilateral veto (16.5%).

Exam-Style Practice Questions & Detailed Solutions

Part 1: UN Genesis, Principal Organs & Term Limits (Q1 to Q5)

Q1. On which date did the Charter of the United Nations officially come into legal force following its ratification by the permanent members and a majority of signatory nations?

(A) 26 June 1945 (B) 24 October 1945
(C) 30 October 1945 (D) 1 January 1946

Sol. Q1. Entry into Force of the UN Charter:

- The UN officially came into legal existence on **24 October 1945**, when the Charter was ratified by the P5 and a majority of signatories. This date is observed worldwide as United Nations Day.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q2. India formally signed the United Nations Charter, becoming an original founding member state of the world organisation, on which specific date?

(A) 15 August 1947 (B) 24 October 1945
(C) 30 October 1945 (D) 26 January 1950

Sol. Q2. India's Accession to the UN:

- India signed the UN Charter in San Francisco on **30 October 1945**, entering as one of the 51 original founding members before achieving formal sovereign independence.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q3. Which sovereign state was admitted as the 193rd member state of the United Nations General Assembly in July 2011?

(A) South Sudan (B) East Timor
(C) Montenegro (D) Switzerland

Sol. Q3. 193rd Member State of the UN:

- **South Sudan** was formally admitted as the 193rd member state of the United Nations in **July 2011**, following its successful independence referendum from Sudan.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q4. Under Article 23 of the United Nations Charter, the ten non-permanent members of the Security Council are elected by the General Assembly for a term of:

(A) One year (B) Three years
(C) Five years (D) Two years

Sol. Q4. Tenure of Non-Permanent UNSC Members:

- The 10 non-permanent members of the UN Security Council are elected for staggered **two-year terms** and cannot be immediately re-elected for an adjacent term.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q5. Which principal organ of the United Nations formally suspended its operations on 1 November 1994 following the independence of Palau, the last remaining trust territory?

(A) The Trusteeship Council (B) The Economic and Social Council
(C) The International Court of Justice (D) The Commission on Human Rights

Sol. Q5. Suspension of the Trusteeship Council:

- The **Trusteeship Council** formally suspended its operations on **1 November 1994** after Palau, the last remaining United Nations trust territory, achieved sovereignty.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Part 2: Judicial Seat, Leadership, Trade & Coffee Club (Q6 to Q10)

Q6. The International Court of Justice (ICJ), comprising 15 judges elected for nine-year terms, is permanently seated in which international city?

(A) The Hague, Netherlands
(B) Geneva, Switzerland
(C) Vienna, Austria
(D) New York, United States

Sol. Q6. Permanent Seat of the ICJ:

- The International Court of Justice (ICJ) is the only principal organ of the UN located outside New York; it is permanently seated at the Peace Palace in **The Hague, Netherlands**.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q7. Which United Nations Secretary-General died in a suspicious plane crash in the Congo in September 1961 and was posthumously awarded the Nobel Peace Prize?

(A) Trygve Lie
(B) Dag Hammarskjöld
(C) U Thant
(D) Kurt Waldheim

Sol. Q7. Dag Hammarskjöld's Legacy:

- **Dag Hammarskjöld** of Sweden, the second Secretary-General of the UN and pioneer of UN peacekeeping, died tragically in a plane crash in 1961 during the Congo crisis and received a posthumous Nobel Peace Prize.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q8. The World Trade Organization (WTO) officially succeeded the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) following the Marrakesh Agreement on which date?

(A) 24 October 1945
(B) 1 January 1991
(C) 1 January 1995
(D) 11 December 2001

Sol. Q8. Establishment of the WTO:

- The **World Trade Organization (WTO)** officially commenced operations on **1 January 1995**, succeeding the provisional GATT framework and headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q9. The International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA), established under President Dwight Eisenhower's 'Atoms for Peace' initiative in 1957, is headquartered in:

(A) Geneva, Switzerland
(B) Paris, France
(C) Brussels, Belgium
(D) Vienna, Austria

Sol. Q9. Headquarters of the IAEA:

- The **IAEA** was established in **1957** and is permanently headquartered at the Vienna International Centre in **Vienna, Austria**, to inspect nuclear programs worldwide.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q10. The international diplomatic coalition of regional rivals (including Pakistan, Italy, Argentina, and South Korea) opposing the G4 bid for permanent UNSC seats is known as:

(A) The Non-Aligned Movement
(B) Uniting for Consensus (The Coffee Club)
(C) The Cairns Group
(D) The Group of 77

Sol. Q10. The 'Coffee Club' Opposition:

- The **Uniting for Consensus** coalition (popularly known as the **Coffee Club**), led by Italy, Pakistan, Mexico, and Argentina, opposes permanent seat expansion for the G4 nations.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Part 3: IMF Veto, Reform Criteria & Global Civil Society (Q11 to Q15)

Q11. Under the weighted quota voting architecture of the International Monetary Fund (IMF), which single member state holds over 16.5% of total votes, conferring an effective unilateral veto?

(A) Japan
(B) Germany
(C) The United States
(D) The People's Republic of China

Sol. Q11. Unilateral US Veto in the IMF:

- Because major institutional amendments and policy resolutions in the IMF require an 85% supermajority, the **United States** (holding 16.5% of total voting power) possesses an effective unilateral veto.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q12. In 1997, which United Nations Secretary-General proposed the landmark six qualitative and quantitative criteria for admitting new permanent members to an expanded Security Council?

(A) Kofi Annan
(B) Boutros Boutros-Ghali
(C) Ban Ki-moon
(D) Javier Pérez de Cuéllar

Sol. Q12. Kofi Annan's Reform Criteria:

- In **1997**, Secretary-General **Kofi Annan** presented the six criteria for assessing prospective permanent members of the UNSC (economic size, military capacity, financial contribution, population, democracy, and diversity).

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q13. On 15 March 2006, the United Nations General Assembly voted overwhelmingly to establish which standing subsidiary body, officially replacing the discredited Commission on Human Rights?

(A) The Peacebuilding Commission
(B) The International Criminal Court
(C) The United Nations Democracy Fund
(D) The UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC)

Sol. Q13. Establishment of the UNHRC:

- The **UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC)** was established by UNGA Resolution 60/251 on **15 March 2006**, replacing the politicized Commission on Human Rights to conduct universal periodic human rights reviews.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q14. Amnesty International, a prominent global human rights non-governmental organisation that was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 1977, was founded in London in 1961 by:

(A) Henri Dunant
(B) Peter Benenson
(C) Eleanor Roosevelt
(D) Sean MacBride

Sol. Q14. Founding of Amnesty International:

- **Peter Benenson**, a British lawyer, founded **Amnesty International** in London in **1961** after launching an appeal for the release of two Portuguese students imprisoned for raising a toast to freedom.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q15. Which diplomatic norm, endorsed by world leaders at the 2005 UN World Summit, affirms that the international community has a duty to intervene when sovereign states fail to protect citizens from genocide?

(A) Universal Jurisdiction
(B) The Monroe Doctrine
(C) Responsibility to Protect (R2P)
(D) Democratic Peace Theory

Sol. Q15. The Responsibility to Protect (R2P):

- Formally endorsed at the **2005 UN World Summit**, the **Responsibility to Protect (R2P)** principle establishes that sovereignty is not absolute and the international community must intervene when states fail to shield citizens from atrocities.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**